TechAbout Customer Support Assessment

Candidate Information

Name: Malaika Azhar

Queue: PKHosting + Travel.pk (one agent, both queues)

Shift date: Friday, 6 November 2026

Assessment focus: triage, accurate replies, security judgment, bilingual support

Assessment Overview

Eight tickets, two brands, one shift. I read the published pages first, then decided the order of work, then wrote what I'd send and the internal notes. Where a page doesn't say something, I say so and ask. I don't make up a rule.

What I Read First

- **pkhosting.com/refund (Aug 2026):** first-time shared/WordPress orders can be reviewed within 7 days of payment, before meaningful use or migration work. Domains, SSL/add-ons, VPS/dedicated, setup and migration fees, taxes and gateway charges are non-refundable. Approved refunds return in 7-10 business days. No outage-refund rule.
- **pkhosting.com homepage:** live chat/phone Mon-Fri 9am-6pm PKT, tickets answered daily. Daily backups are on the same server, best-effort restore, no recovery-time SLA. Free SSL on every plan; free migration is listed. Personal 5 GB, Business 25 GB, Professional 50 GB.
- **travel.pk/refund-policy (v2.0, 10 Aug 2026):** the airline controls disruption options and compensation. A delay does not automatically create a refund. Promo or restricted fares can be non-refundable. There is no universal fee table.
- **travel.pk Terms of Service:** a payment receipt or processing status is not a ticket; Travel.pk is not liable for delays.
- **travel.pk homepage and Trust Centre:** staff Mon-Fri 10am-7pm PKT. "Payment received", "processing" and "ticket issued" are different states. Escalation: legal@travel.pk with the ticket reference.
- **Not found** in the terms, refund policy, homepage or Trust Centre: a "Best Price Guarantee" or an "on-time promise". I treat both claims (T-7, T-8) as unverified and do not confirm them. I did not read the Help Center; I would check it before sending.

Why Friday Matters

Travel.pk staff leave at 7pm and are off on Saturday. That changes how I order the queue.

A. Triage Table

Order of work: T-6, T-4, T-1, T-8, T-3, T-7, T-2, T-5. First-response targets are the time to the customer's first reply.

Ticket	System / Area	Priority	First response	Owner	Reasoning
T-6	Travel.pk — Payment & Booking	P1 — Critical	10 min	Me, then ticketing/payments	Money taken, no ticket, flight tomorrow, and staff are gone from 7pm Friday.
T-4	PKHosting — Account Security	P1 — Critical	15 min	Me, then manager + sysadmin	Possible account takeover. A safe hold is quick, so it goes second.
T-1	PKHosting — Website down	P1 — Critical	15 min	Sysadmin; I own the customer	Site down overnight, customer's Eid deadline in 4 days. Fix first, refund talk later.
T-8	Travel.pk — Flight delay	P2 — High	30 min	Me; ops for airline contact	Review threat in 2 hours. Needs a calm, accurate answer, not a promise.
T-3	PKHosting — Billing & refund	P3 — Medium	2 hrs	Me; billing for the record	Day 19 is outside the 7-day window, so it's a no. Left unanswered, it can become a chargeback.
T-7	Travel.pk — Booking policy	P3 — Medium	2 hrs	Me	Needs fare rules and flight date. If the flight is close, it moves up before 7pm.
T-2	PKHosting — SSL / CDN	P3 — Medium	4 hrs	Sysadmin; I collect info	Site loads, but the warning costs visitors. Needs diagnosis, not panic.
T-5	PKHosting — Migration	P3 — Medium	4 hrs	Migration team; I scope	Planned work. Needs sizes and a quiet window before any time quote.

Prioritization Method Used

P1 — Critical Security risk, money taken, or a customer who cannot act today.	**P2 — High** Service or deadline affected, but a calm answer comes first.	**P3 — Medium** Needs investigation or scoping before any promise, or a policy answer that must still be sent today.	**P4 — Low** Policy question with a clear answer and no deadline. Replied to the same day.

B. Customer Replies: PKHosting

Each reply is 200 words or fewer and ends with a next step and a time. [Brackets] are filled in per customer.

Ticket T-1 — Site down, wants a refund

Channel: ticket/email. Voice: sorry, plain, no invented compensation.

Hi [Name],

I'm really sorry. Your site was down all night and nobody answered you at 2am. Our live chat and phone only run Monday to Friday, 9am to 6pm PKT, so overnight, tickets were the only way in. I know that's no comfort with a deadline coming up.

I've passed this to our sysadmin as urgent. Please send me your domain name and a screenshot of the database error. Please don't send any passwords.

We keep daily backups on the server, so we'll check what's there. I can't promise a restore until we've looked, but I'll tell you exactly what we find.

On the refund: our policy covers first-time hosting orders within 7 days of payment, and it has no refund for outages, so I can't promise one. I've noted your request for my manager, and we'll come back to it once the site is stable.

You'll hear from me again within 30 minutes, and then every hour until it's back up.

[Agent name]
PKHosting Support

Ticket T-3 — Day 19, wants everything refunded today

Channel: ticket/email. I hold the line: state the policy, don't soften the no, keep the customer. Check before sending: Professional is a shared plan under the refund page (the homepage lists it with the web hosting plans).

Hi [Name],

Thanks for telling me plainly what you want. I'll be just as plain.

We review refunds for first-time hosting orders within 7 days of payment, and you're on day 19, so I can't refund the hosting fee. The domain and the setup fee can't be refunded either once they're processed, because that money is spent straight away. I know that's not what you hoped to hear.

What I can do: if something on the service isn't working, tell me what and I'll get it looked at today. If you just want to stop, I'll show you how to cancel from your dashboard before the renewal invoice is paid, so you aren't charged again. If you want our billing team to look at it, email billing@pkhosting.com with your order number. I can't promise they'll change the answer.

I'll check your account and write back by 6pm today.

[Agent name]
PKHosting Support

Ticket T-4 — Gmail sender claiming to be the new IT manager

Channel: email to the Gmail address. Gives nothing away about the account. I won't guess, but I'm not shutting the door.

Hello,

Thanks for writing. I'm sorry, but I can't reset a password or change any account details on a request from someone we haven't verified, however urgent it is. Everyone gets the same rule, and it's what protects every customer. For the same reason I can't say whether any account exists or share anything about one.

Please don't offer payment. It won't change what I can do.

Nothing on any account will change unless the registered owner confirms it. If you work for the business that owns a service with us, the owner can confirm from the email address registered on the account, or send a signed authorisation on company letterhead with the signatory's ID. Send it to support@pkhosting.com and we'll review it within one business day of receiving it.

[Agent name]
PKHosting Support

B. Customer Replies: Travel.pk

Ticket T-6 — JazzCash paid, no e-ticket (Roman Urdu, WhatsApp)

Channel: WhatsApp. Register: polite, warm, short sentences.

Assalam-o-Alaikum [Name] sahib/sahiba,

Main samajh sakti hoon ke aap pareshan hain. Flight kal hai, payment ho chuki hai aur ticket abhi tak nahi aaya. Sab se pehle main yehi dekh rahi hoon.

Aap yahin WhatsApp par JazzCash ka Transaction ID (TID) ya payment ka screenshot bhej dein, aur booking reference bhi agar mila ho. Card ya CNIC ki details mat bhejiye, wo hamein nahi chahiye. Jab tak main confirm na karun, dobara payment mat kijiye, warna double charge ho sakta hai.

Ek baat saaf kar dun: payment aana aur ticket issue hona do alag cheezein hain. Pehle hum dekhte hain ke payment humare paas match hui ya nahi, phir ye ke airline ne booking confirm ki ya nahi. Jab tak confirm na ho, main ye nahi kahungi ke ticket ban gaya.

Hamari team aaj Jumma ko shaam 7 baje tak hai, aur kal available nahi hogi. 30 minute ke andar main isi chat mein bata dungi ke payment aur booking ka kya status hai. Agar aaj ticket issue na ho saka, to 7 baje se pehle saaf bata dungi, taake aap kal ke liye koi aur intezam kar sakein.

Travel.pk Support

Ticket T-6 — Same reply in English

Channel: WhatsApp or email. Same facts as the Urdu version, written for English.

Hi [Name],

I know this is stressful. Your flight is tomorrow, you've paid, and there's no ticket. I'm looking at it right now.

Please send me, here on WhatsApp, your JazzCash Transaction ID (TID) or a screenshot of the payment, plus your booking reference if you have one. Please don't send card details or your CNIC, we don't need them. And please don't pay again until I confirm, or you could be charged twice.

One thing I want to be clear about: payment received and ticket issued are two different steps. First we check that your payment matched, then whether the airline confirmed the booking. Until that's confirmed, I won't tell you the ticket is done.

Our team is here until 7pm today (Friday) and isn't available tomorrow. Within 30 minutes I'll tell you exactly where your payment and booking stand. If we can't get the ticket issued today, I'll tell you before 7pm so you can sort something else out for tomorrow.

Travel.pk Support

Ticket T-7 — Promo fare, free date change "under the Best Price Guarantee"

Channel: email/ticket. I don't invent the promise and I don't brush it off, I check it.

Hi [Name],

Thanks for getting in touch about changing your date. Let me tell you what I can and can't promise.

Once a ticket is issued, changes follow the airline's written fare rules, and promo fares often limit changes or rule them out. If there's a fee, it should come from the airline's calculation or an amount we showed you before you paid.

I looked for a Best Price Guarantee in our terms and refund policy and couldn't find one, so I can't promise a free change on that basis. If you saw it somewhere, send me a screenshot or link and I'll read exactly what it says.

In the meantime I'll pull the fare rules for your booking and write out whether a change is allowed and what it would cost. Please send your booking reference, your flight date and the new date you want. Don't change or cancel anything yet, since some changes can't be undone.

I'll send you that breakdown by 5pm today.

[Agent name]
Travel.pk Support

Ticket T-8 — 3h10m delay, wants a full refund, review threat

Channel: WhatsApp or email. The 2-hour deadline changes how fast I reply, not the policy.

Hi [Name],

I'm sorry about the three-hour delay. It's frustrating, especially when you planned around the time.

The airline decides schedules and any compensation, and our refund policy says a delay doesn't automatically mean a refund. I looked for an on-time promise in our terms and refund policy and didn't find one, so I can't confirm a full refund on that basis. If you saw one, send me a screenshot and I'll check it today.

What I can do right now is ask the airline what it will offer: rebooking, credit, or a refund if its rules allow one. Please send your booking reference and the airline's delay notice if you have it. Don't accept or cancel anything until you've seen what each option means, because some can't be reversed.

You're free to leave a review whatever happens. I'd just like you to have a real answer first.

I'll update you within 30 minutes on where it stands. The airline sets how fast it replies, so I'll tell you what I know either way. If it's still unresolved after that, you can ask for a formal escalation at legal@travel.pk with this ticket's reference.

[Agent name]
Travel.pk Support

C. Diagnostic Notes

Internal notes, not replies.

Ticket T-2 — "Not secure" in Chrome after a free CDN

Questions, in order

1. What exactly does Chrome show: a full-page certificate error, or only a "Not secure" label on a page that loads? (screenshot)
2. Which CDN, and what SSL mode is set between visitor, CDN and origin (flexible, full, full strict)? A screenshot of that one setting.
3. Does every page show it, or only some? Any page with images, scripts or forms that load over http://?
4. When did the nameservers or DNS records change, and are any old records still pointing straight at the origin?
5. Did the site show a padlock before the CDN was added?

My theory

"Not secure" in Chrome means the page is loading over plain http. Most likely there's no https redirect, or the CDN's own certificate isn't active yet, or its SSL mode doesn't match what the origin serves. My second guess: the page loads over https but something on it still loads over http (mixed content).

What would disprove it

If our public SSL checker shows a valid certificate for the domain, and `curl -I http://domain.com` redirects to https, my first guess is wrong. If the browser console shows no mixed-content lines either, the second is wrong too. Then I'd look for an old DNS record or a bad certificate cached on the visitor's side, and test in a private window on another device.

What I won't ask them to send

CDN or hosting passwords, API tokens, private keys, or screenshots of dashboards that show tokens. A screenshot of the SSL mode setting and the browser warning is enough.

Sysadmin checks (read-only, from outside)

```
dig +short domain.com
dig NS domain.com
curl -I http://domain.com
curl -I https://domain.com
openssl s_client -connect domain.com:443 \
  -servername domain.com
```

What I read from it: does http redirect to https; the issuer; whether the subject/SAN matches the domain; the not-after date. I'd also use PKHosting's public DNS Checker and SSL Checker, and the browser console for mixed-content lines.

Ticket T-5 — Assisted migration of a 12 GB WooCommerce store

Questions, in order

1. Where is it hosted now, and can they give us a full site backup or a way in that they can revoke afterwards?
2. How is the 12 GB split: database size versus uploads? How many products and orders?
3. When are they quietest, and how many orders on a normal day? Can they pause orders for a short window?
4. Which plugins touch orders: payment gateways, subscriptions, stock sync, shipping? Do any use webhooks tied to the old URL?
5. Who controls the DNS, and can the TTL be lowered a day or two before the move? Is email on the same host?

My theory (to confirm)

I'm assuming the 12 GB is mostly images, which copy quickly, but question 2 will tell me. The real risk is orders that arrive between the last database copy and the DNS switch. So: a test copy first, a short order freeze at cutover, one final database

sync, then DNS. After cutover I compare the order count and the latest order time on old and new, then run one test checkout.

Plan fit and refund note

12 GB doesn't fit the 5 GB Personal plan, and backups need room, so this belongs on Business (25 GB) or Professional (50 GB). Before work starts, tell the customer that migration work can affect refund eligibility under the refund page.

What would disprove it

A large or busy database (many orders an hour, subscriptions, heavy writes) means a freeze is too disruptive, and we'd need a staged sync or a night window. I won't quote a downtime number until I have the database size and how long the test copy took.

What I won't ask them to send

cPanel or WordPress admin passwords in chat or email, wp-config.php (it holds the database credentials), a database dump attached to an email, or payment gateway keys.

D. Escalation Note: T-4 (150 words max)

To: [Manager], [Sysadmin on shift]. **Subject:** T-4 possible account takeover, nothing changed

A Gmail sender, signing as the "new IT manager", asked us to reset the password and change the account email to his. He offered a fee and says the old developer can't be reached.

What I did NOT do: reset the password, change the email, confirm the account exists, share any account detail, discuss the fee, or contact anyone.

What I did: sent a reply that gives nothing away and names the only route: owner confirmation from the registered email, or signed authorisation.

Why I'm worried: unverified sender, urgency, a payment offer, and a reason the real owner can't confirm. It's the usual shape of a takeover.

Please: sysadmin, check recent logins and changes on the account, read only. Manager, decide how we reach the registered owner. Nobody acts until then.

I'll update you by 6pm today.

E. Macros

Macro 1 — PKHosting: refund outside the 7-day window

Placeholders: {{customer_name}} {{order_id}} {{payment_date}} {{days_since_payment}} {{followup_time}} {{agent_name}}

Hi {{customer_name}},

Thanks for writing about order {{order_id}}. I checked it against our refund policy. First-time shared hosting orders can be reviewed for a refund within 7 days of payment. Yours was paid on {{payment_date}}, which is {{days_since_payment}} days ago, so I can't refund the hosting fee. Domain registrations and setup or migration fees can't be refunded once processed.

If something isn't working, tell me what and I'll get it checked. If you want to stop, you can cancel from your dashboard before the next renewal invoice is paid.

I'll write back by {{followup_time}}.

{{agent_name}}, PKHosting Support

Do not use when: the request is inside 7 days; the reason is an outage or a fault on our side; the product is VPS or dedicated (different rules); the customer mentions a chargeback; or the sender isn't verified as the account owner (see T-4).

Macro 2 — Travel.pk: flight delay or schedule change

Placeholders: {{customer_name}} {{flight_number}} {{new_departure_time}} {{booking_ref}} {{followup_time}} {{agent_name}}

Hi {{customer_name}},

I'm sorry about the delay on {{flight_number}}, now leaving at {{new_departure_time}}. The airline decides schedules and any compensation, and a delay doesn't automatically mean a refund. If you have the airline's notice, please send it with booking reference {{booking_ref}}.

I'll check the options it gives, like rebooking, credit or a refund, and send them to you by {{followup_time}}. Please don't accept or cancel anything until we've gone through them, because some choices can't be reversed.

{{agent_name}}, Travel.pk Support

Do not use when: payment isn't matched or no ticket was issued yet; the airline has already cancelled and given its own instructions; the customer is at the airport and needs live help; or they ask for a written refund calculation.

F. Policy Knowledge Gaps: Five Questions the Public Pages Don’t Answer

#	Question	My assumption	Who I’d ask
1	What identity standard applies when someone other than the registered owner asks for a password reset or an email change?	Registered-email confirmation, or signed company authorisation plus ID. Nothing less, whatever the reason or the fee offered.	Manager / security owner
2	Is there any credit or compensation for an outage? The pages state no recovery-time SLA.	None unless a manager approves it case by case. I promise nothing in the first reply.	Operations manager
3	Do the “Best Price Guarantee” and “on-time promise” exist anywhere (Help Center, app, ad)?	I couldn’t find them in the homepage, terms, refund policy or Trust Centre, so I treat customer claims as unverified, ask for a screenshot, and don’t confirm them.	Travel.pk marketing / product owner
4	Who covers Travel.pk same-day travel problems after 7pm Friday and on weekends?	No one is on shift, so a ticketing emergency is escalated to an on-call person by phone.	Travel operations manager
5	The plans list free migration, but the refund page lists migration fees. Which migrations cost money?	Free for eligible sites on a plan. Any paid assisted or complex move is quoted in writing before work starts.	Migration team lead / billing

G. Clarity Audit

Their lines are short excerpts or close paraphrases so you can find them; the full text is in the section named. “Mine” is proposed wording and needs product-owner sign-off.

#	Where	Their line	Problem	Mine (proposed)
1	PKHosting refund page, section 1: when does “meaningful use” start?	The page says a request qualifies only if made before “meaningful use”, migration work, abuse or third-party costs.	A customer can’t tell whether uploading a file or adding an email counts, so every refusal feels arbitrary.	“To qualify, ask within 7 days of payment and before your site has gone live, email or data has been moved in, or a domain or other third-party item has been bought for you.”
2	Travel.pk refund page: “When a flight is disrupted” vs “Refund Conditions”	One section says a delay does not automatically create a refund. Another says “applicable passenger-rights rules” help decide eligibility, without naming them.	A customer reads the second as a promise and the first as a refusal. Without named rules, even an agent can’t say which apply to which airline or route.	“A delay does not automatically entitle you to a refund. What you can get depends on the airline’s notice and the rules of the operating airline and route. We will tell you which apply and submit the option you choose.”
3	PKHosting refund page, section 3: an internal note on a customer page	A line telling the Terms editors not to turn refunds into account credit “at PKHosting’s discretion”.	This reads like an instruction to staff, not to customers. A customer can’t tell whether a refund could ever turn into account credit.	“Refunds are paid to your original payment method. We don’t replace a refund with account credit unless you ask for it.”